

Akshay Danthi

San Francisco, CA • 628-468-2958 • akshaydanthi19@gmail.com

[LinkedIn](#) • [Portfolio](#)

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Hiring Manager
Higher Ed Courseware Product Management

Hello,

I believe I'm a strong fit for the Senior Technical Product Manager - AI role. I build learning tools that students and advisors/instructors actually use, and I back every decision with research and clear metrics. Most recently, as the founding AI PM at a higher ed career-prep platform, I shipped Ana, a GenAI advisor that cut staff time by about 160 hours a week and lifted weekly student adoption from 24 percent to 52 percent across paying institutions. I also led a cross-functional launch of a real-time speech to speech interview simulator. That release grew WAU 20 percent in 6 weeks and turned 3 pilots into paid customers.

Your focus areas speak to what I do best. Writing Solutions, MediaShare, and Freehand Grader are core to open-form assignments. My product style is hands-on discovery paired with rigorous performance analysis. I run fast, structured JTBD-style interviews with users, other stakeholders, and subject matter experts, I instrument the funnels that matter, and I translate what we learn into a clear, testable roadmap that Engineering, Design, and Marketing can rally around.

A few examples from my experience that map to your needs

- Strategy rooted in evidence: I have owned competitive and market analysis, set outcome-based roadmaps, and added practical evals and guardrails for LLM features so they are actually relevant, useful, and safe.
- Cross-functional execution: I have aligned more than fifteen global stakeholders on onboarding and configuration work, then delivered iterative releases through Agile rituals with 85% CSAT.
- Measurement culture: I define a small scorecard, stand up lightweight dashboards, and review leading indicators weekly. I have shipped features that cut report turnaround from days to minutes.
- End to end ownership and GTM: From discovery and design to pricing, packaging, demos, and enablement, I partner with Sales and Customer Success to drive adoption and retention.

How I would approach the first 90 days

1) Listen, watch, and size the problems. Meet instructors and students, review funnels for authoring, submission, and grading, and benchmark time to first feedback, resubmission quality, and instructor time per submission.

2) Pick a small set of north star and input metrics. For example, assignment completion rate, rubric to feedback alignment, weekly active instructors and students, and grading time per submission.

3) Tackle three high-leverage bets.

- Writing Solutions: formative feedback that maps to instructor rubrics, multilingual and accessibility-first, with strong guardrails so we assist rather than overwrite student work.
- MediaShare: instant transcription and captioning, quick prompts for reflection, and content safety checks in the upload flow.
- Freehand Grader: calibration flows for graders, AI-suggested rubric descriptors, and bulk feedback tools that keep educators in control.

4) Prove value with clean experiments. Ship behind feature flags, run A/B tests with opt-in cohorts, and measure learning impact alongside engagement.

5) Enable the field. Clear positioning, short demos tied to instructor pain points, and adoption playbooks for Customer Success.

I bring a practical, collaborative style and I am comfortable creating clarity in ambiguous spaces. I would love to help grow these products and improve outcomes for instructors and students.

Thank you for your time and consideration. I am happy to share work samples and talk through approach.

Best regards,
Akshay Danthi